

AEROSPACE AND DEFENSE

The AS9100 Readiness Checklist

The gaps that pass internal review and fail the audit.

This checklist shows how we walk through AS9100 readiness with clients. Work through it honestly, with the people who actually run the floor. The value is not in the boxes you check. It is in the items you cannot confidently check, because those are the gaps that surface in a certification audit, not before.

One note before you start: this surfaces the gaps we see most in the field. It is not a substitute for a clause-by-clause gap assessment against the standard.

01 Leadership and Ownership

- ☐ Leadership can explain what AS9100 requires of them, not just of the quality function.
- ☐ One person owns the implementation, with the authority and the hours to run it.
- ☐ Implementation time is protected as scheduled working sessions, not fit in around the edges.
- ☐ Progress is visible on one dashboard: last week's results, this week's expectations, and the status of key system documentation.

02 Right-Sized Documentation

- ☐ Every procedure has passed a necessary-versus-unnecessary review. If it does not add value, it is gone.
- ☐ The documented process is the process actually running on the floor.
- ☐ Work instructions exist where the risk lives, not everywhere.
- ☐ No document exists only for the auditor's benefit.

03 Process Control and Quality at the Source

- ☐ Process controls operate in practice, not just on paper.
- ☐ Problems are caught where the work happens, not at final inspection.
- ☐ Corrective actions close the root cause, not just the paperwork.
- ☐ Any claim in your quality manual can be traced to evidence from the floor.

04 Supply Chain

- ☐ Suppliers are held to the same standard as your own floor.
- ☐ Requirements flow down to suppliers, and evidence flows back.
- ☐ You know which supplier would fail your own audit tomorrow.

05 **Integration and Sustainment**

- ☐ The quality system is woven into how the business already runs, not bolted on.
- ☐ Reviews and internal audits still happen in busy weeks, not only in slow ones.
- ☐ The team can keep the system running without an auditor in the room.
- ☐ The system is always audit-ready. Nobody scrambles to prep for the recertification audit.

06 **The Aerospace-Specific Requirements**

- ☐ Configuration is controlled: the floor builds to the proper engineering revision.
- ☐ Counterfeit parts prevention is a working process, not a policy statement.
- ☐ Product safety has an owner, and people can name their role in it.
- ☐ Foreign object debris prevention is built into daily floor routines.
- ☐ First article inspection is planned, and the evidence is retained.
- ☐ Risk is managed where AS9100 requires it: in planning and in operations.

WHAT RIGHT-SIZED LOOKS LIKE

A growing space-hardware company came to CBS needing AS9100 certification on a tight timeline, with a small team and no dedicated quality function. CBS applied lean thinking and right-sized the system, and the quality system was woven into how the business already ran. After a concentrated four-month surge, the initial certification audit came back with a recommendation for certification.

“They kept things on track, coached our team perfectly, and kept the tone just right. Ultimately, the results speak for themselves.”

Chief Operating Officer, Agile Space Industries

Bring the boxes you could not check.

Set up a call with one of our consultants. We will tell you which gaps matter most, which an auditor finds first, and what we would do about them. Straight answers.

[SET UP A CALL](#)